



Cognitive Psychology (COGPSY)

Module 4: Thinking, Language, Reasoning and Judgment

Thinking and Problem Solving

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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Thinking

Thinking is the mental activity of working with information: forming ideas, solving problems, and deciding what to do. It depends on what you noticed and what you can retrieve, which is why attention and memory matter for thinking.

Language and Thought

Language helps us label ideas, share them, and think in words. In Uganda many students move between English and other languages. That can support flexible thinking, and it can add load when a concept is first learned in a second language. Clear definitions in the language of instruction still matter for exams and professional work.

Problem Solving

A simple path is: define the problem clearly, generate possible approaches, choose and try one, then check the result and adjust. Students often jump to the first idea. Slowing down to define the problem saves time later.

Reflect: Before your next hard assignment, write the problem in one clear sentence. Does that change how you start?

Closing

The next lesson covers reasoning, judgment, and bias.